

MODERN TEACHING STRATEGIES

A Comprehensive One-Month Training Program for Educators

Instructional Design · Full Curriculum · Trainer's Facilitation Guide

Differentiation · Accommodation · UDL · Active Learning · Assessment · Feedback

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Program Philosophy

Teaching is not the transmission of information — it is the engineering of conditions in which learning becomes possible. This program is built on the conviction that teachers, like the learners they serve, are not empty vessels to be filled with strategies, but complex professionals whose growth is most durable when it is grounded in reflection, connected to lived practice, and anchored in a coherent educational philosophy.

The four weeks of this program are therefore not merely a strategy acquisition course. They are an invitation to examine assumptions, expand repertoire, experiment deliberately, and commit — not to doing everything differently at once, but to moving intentionally in the direction of teaching that is more equitable, more responsive, and more deeply effective for every learner in the room.

Educators who complete this program will not emerge as perfect teachers. They will emerge as more reflective ones — and in the long arc of a teaching career, that is the more powerful transformation.

How to Use This Document

- Facilitators should read the full document before delivering any session — the weeks build deliberately on each other
- Session plans are detailed guides, not rigid scripts — adapt timing, activities, and examples to your participants' context
- Every reflection prompt is designed for written response in participants' Reflection Journals — protect this time
- Appendix materials are designed to be printed and distributed; digital versions also work well
- The program is designed for delivery over 20 sessions (4 weeks, 5 sessions per week), each 90–150 minutes — adapt scheduling to your context while preserving the weekly thematic arc

Instructional Design Framework

The design of this program reflects a deliberate, theoretically grounded approach to professional development — one that treats teachers as adult learners, values prior experience as a learning resource, and measures success not by knowledge acquisition but by observable change in professional practice. Rather than adopting a single instructional design model, this program uses a hybrid framework that integrates five complementary theoretical traditions.

The Hybrid Instructional Design Model

The program is built on five interlocking theoretical foundations, each operating at a different level of the design process:

FRAMEWORK	ORIGIN	ROLE IN THIS PROGRAM
ADDIE	Dick, Carey & Carey	Provides the macro-level design sequence: Analysis (needs/context), Design (objectives/structure), Development (materials), Implementation (facilitation), Evaluation (formative + summative). The overall program architecture follows this process.
Understanding by Design (UbD)	Wiggins & McTighe	Each week and session begins with desired results (what will participants know, do, and be?) and works backwards to design assessments and then learning experiences. This ensures alignment between objectives, tasks, and evidence of learning.
Andragogy	Malcolm Knowles	Shapes the facilitation philosophy throughout. Knowles' six principles (self-concept, experience, readiness, orientation to learning, motivation, need to know) inform how sessions are framed, how relevance is established, and how participants are positioned as co-constructors of meaning rather than recipients of instruction.
Experiential Learning Cycle	David Kolb	Provides the session-level structural logic. Each session moves through four stages: Concrete Experience (a task, activity, or provocation), Reflective Observation (what did I notice?), Abstract Conceptualization (what framework explains this?), and Active Experimentation (how will I apply this?). The sequence is visible in the architecture of every day's plan.
Reflective Practice	Donald Schon	Embedded in every session's daily reflection prompt, the weekly workshop days, and the Capstone Action Research project. Schon's distinction between reflection-in-action (real-time adjustment) and reflection-on-action (post-experience analysis) structures both micro-teaching debriefs and the overall program arc.

Why a Hybrid Model?

No single instructional design framework adequately addresses the full complexity of professional teacher development. ADDIE provides the engineering scaffold for program coherence; UbD ensures every session earns its place by connecting to clear evidence of professional growth; Andragogy keeps the facilitation philosophy grounded in what actually motivates and sustains adult learning; Kolb's cycle ensures that every input is connected to experience and followed by application; and Schon's reflective practice ensures that the program's benefits extend beyond the four weeks into sustainable, self-directed professional growth.

The result is a program that is simultaneously rigorous in its design, responsive in its facilitation, and transferable in its impact — a program that does not merely expose teachers to modern strategies, but genuinely develops their capacity to design for all learners, reflect on their own practice, and continue growing long after the final session.

How the ID Model Shapes the Program Structure

- The four-week arc reflects ADDIE's Implementation phase and UbD's logic: foundations first, then tools, then application, then assessment and reflection
- Each week builds on the previous one — you cannot effectively differentiate (Week 2) without understanding who your learners are (Week 1); you cannot assess effectively (Week 4) without knowing what active learning looks like (Week 3)
- Kolb's cycle is visible in every session: participants experience first (do), then reflect (what did I notice?), then conceptualize (what framework applies?), then plan (what will I try?)
- Andragogy is evident in the persistent "why does this matter for my students?" framing, the use of participants' own lessons as design materials, and the self-directed capstone inquiry
- Schon's reflective practice is operationalized through the daily reflection prompts, the weekly micro-teaching and demonstration workshops, and the Action Research design in the final session

Program Overview

Vision & Mission

"To develop reflective, learner-centered educators who design with intention, differentiate with confidence, teach with energy, and assess with integrity."

This program exists because teaching excellence is not a trait — it is a set of practices that can be learned, refined, and deepened over a professional lifetime. Its mission is to accelerate that process by providing teachers with the theoretical grounding, practical tools, structured practice, and reflective habits they need to move from competent instruction to genuinely transformative teaching.

Program Learning Objectives

By the end of this program, participants will be able to:

1. Articulate a coherent, evidence-informed personal teaching philosophy and describe how it shapes instructional decision-making
2. Design differentiated lessons that respond to learner variability in readiness, interest, and learning profile, using Tomlinson's framework and UDL principles
3. Apply at least three accommodation and scaffolding strategies to support diverse learners without reducing rigor or lowering expectations
4. Facilitate active learning sessions using Project-Based Learning, cooperative structures, and technology-enhanced design with confidence and intentionality
5. Design and implement formative and summative assessments that are valid, reliable, and aligned to learning objectives
6. Write feedback that is specific, descriptive, actionable, and calibrated to the appropriate level of Hattie and Timperley's feedback model
7. Design a short-cycle Action Research inquiry to sustain professional growth beyond the program

Duration	4 weeks · 20 sessions total · approximately 35–40 hours of professional development
Session Length	Sessions 1–19: 90 minutes each · Session 20 (Capstone): 150 minutes
Format	Face-to-face with optional blended delivery for between-session tasks
Group Size	Optimal: 12–20 participants · Maximum recommended: 24
Target Audience	Pre-service and in-service teachers across all levels (EFL, primary, secondary, adult learning)
Prerequisites	Active teaching experience (current or recent) · Willingness to experiment and reflect honestly
Language of Instruction	English (facilitator may scaffold in Arabic where context requires)
Assessment Mode	Formative (continuous): reflection journals, lesson designs, workshop observations · Summative: Capstone Action Research project

Materials Required

Per Participant:

- Reflection Journal (physical notebook or digital equivalent — used daily throughout the program)
- Program Workbook (printed copy of Appendices A–E plus session worksheets)
- Access to at least three lesson plans from their current teaching context

Per Trainer:

- Full facilitator guide (this document)
- Printed station materials for gallery walks, case studies, and sorting activities
- A4 sticky notes in at least three colors
- Timer (visible to all participants)
- Digital projection for video analysis sessions in Days 1, 6, and 11
- Optional: Certificates of Completion (Appendix E) printed and signed before Session 20

Curriculum Map

The table below provides a high-level overview of the full program arc. Each week is thematically coherent and builds directly on the week before it.

WEEK	THEME	KEY CONCEPTS & FRAMEWORKS	STRATEGIES INTRODUCED	ASSESSMENT MODE
1	Foundations of Modern Teaching	Behaviorism → Constructivism · Vygotzky ZPD · Bloom's Taxonomy · Freire · Gardner MI · Schon's Reflective Practice	Gallery Walk · Fishbowl Discussion · 3-V Mapping · Johari Window · 5R Reflection Protocol · Micro-Teaching	Reflection Journal (daily) · Teaching Inventory · Micro-Teaching Observation Checklist · SMART Goal
2	Differentiation, Accommodation & Inclusion	Tomlinson's DI Model · Readiness / Interest / Learning Profile · Accommodation vs. Modification · Scaffolding / Gradual Release · UDL (CAST)	Tiered Tasks · Choice Boards · Learning Profile Menus · Scaffolding Ladders · UDL Redesign · Flexible Grouping	DI Matrix · Accommodation Sort · UDL Audit · Differentiated Lesson Design · DI Lesson Rubric
3	Active Learning & Engagement Strategies	Active Learning Science · Freeman et al. (2014) · Csikszentmihalyi Flow · Gold Standard PBL · Kagan Cooperative Structures · SAMR Model	Engagement Audit · PBL Unit Design · Jigsaw · Numbered Heads Together · Carousel Brainstorm · Flipped Classroom Design	Lesson Engagement Audit · PBL Blueprint · Cooperative Task Design · Flipped Lesson Design · 3-Lens Observation · Facilitation Self-Assessment
4	Assessment, Feedback & Reflective Practice	Black & Wiliam (1998) · Assessment FOR/AS/OFLearning · Hattie & Timperley Feedback Model · Rubric Design · Backward Design · PDSA Action Research	Assessment Sort · Exit Ticket Design · FA Carousel · Alternative Summative Formats · Rubric Calibration · Peer Feedback · PDSA Inquiry Design	Assessment Philosophy Audit · Exit Ticket Sequence · Analytic Rubric · Feedback Rewrite · Action Research Design · Program Synthesis · Capstone Presentation

Master Syllabus — 20-Session Overview

All 20 sessions are listed below in sequence. Days 5, 10, 15 (Workshop Days) and Day 20 (Capstone) are highlighted as experiential synthesis sessions.

DAY	SESSION TITLE	MINS	FOCUS AREA	PRIMARY DELIVERABLE
1	From Transmission to Transformation — Shifting Teaching Paradigms	90	Learning theories, paradigm shifts, constructivism	Teaching Inventory + Gallery Walk Annotations
2	The Learner-Centered Classroom — Principles in Practice	90	Learner autonomy, voice and choice, SDT	3-V Mapping + Modified Lesson Element
3	Knowing Your Learners — Cognitive Diversity and Multiple Intelligences	90	Gardner MI, cognitive load, learning profiles	MI Audit + "Design for All" Activity
4	Teacher Identity, Agency and Reflective Practice	90	Schon, 5R Framework, teaching philosophy	Teaching Philosophy Draft + 5R Reflection
5	WORKSHOP — Micro-Teaching and Peer Observation	120	Applied practice, peer feedback, goal setting	Micro-Teaching + SMART Goal (formative)
6	Understanding Differentiation — The Tomlinson Framework	90	DI theory, equity vs. equality, readiness/interest/profile	DI Matrix
7	Differentiation in Practice — Tiers, Choice Boards, Profiles	90	Tiered tasks, flexible grouping, EFL DI	Tiered Task + Choice Board Design
8	Accommodation, Modification and Scaffolding	90	Accommodation vs. modification, gradual release	Scaffolding Ladder Design
9	Universal Design for Learning — Designing for All	90	UDL 3 principles, CAST guidelines, proactive inclusion	UDL Lesson Audit + Redesign
10	WORKSHOP — Designing the Differentiated Lesson	120	Integrated DI/UDL lesson design, rubric, peer feedback	Differentiated Lesson (formative)
11	From Passive to Active — The Science of Engagement	90	Active learning research, AER cycle, cognitive demand	Engagement Audit + Passive-to-Active Rewrite
12	Project-Based Learning — Design and Implementation	90	Gold Standard PBL, driving questions, authenticity	PBL Unit Blueprint
13	Cooperative and Collaborative Learning — Structures That Work	90	Kagan structures, Johnson & Johnson 5 elements	Cooperative Task Design

14	Technology-Enhanced Learning and the Flipped Classroom	90	SAMR model, flipped design, digital tool selection	Flipped Lesson Design
15	WORKSHOP — Live Active Learning Demonstration	120	Live facilitation, 3-lens feedback, self-assessment	Facilitation Self-Assessment (formative)
16	Assessment Literacy — FOR, AS and OF Learning	90	Assessment types, validity/reliability, Black & Wiliam	Assessment Philosophy Audit
17	Formative Assessment — Real-Time Data for Learning	90	FA strategies, exit tickets, data-driven decisions	Exit Ticket Sequence (5-session)
18	Summative Assessment Design and Rubrics	90	Performance-based assessment, rubric design, calibration	Analytic Rubric + Calibration Exercise
19	Feedback That Drives Growth — From Evaluation to Dialogue	90	Hattie & Timperley, descriptive feedback, peer protocols	Feedback Rewrite + Peer Feedback Protocol Design
20	CAPSTONE — Action Research and Program Synthesis	150	PDSA inquiry, program synthesis, commitment circle	Action Research Design + Teaching Transformation Commitment

WEEK 1 — FOUNDATIONS OF MODERN TEACHING

Establishing the philosophical and theoretical groundwork for the program

Week Overview

Week 1 creates the conceptual architecture on which the rest of the program rests. Before teachers can meaningfully adopt new strategies, they need to examine — and in some cases, unlearn — deeply held assumptions about what teaching is for, what learning looks like, and who learners are. This week moves from paradigm examination to practical experimentation through daily reflection and a culminating micro-teaching workshop.

Week Learning Objectives

- Trace the evolution of educational philosophy from behaviorist transmission to constructivist and sociocultural models
- Apply major learning theories (Vygotsky, Bloom, Gardner) to classroom design decisions
- Develop a personal teaching philosophy grounded in learner-centered principles
- Establish reflective practice as a sustainable professional habit using the 5R framework

SESSION 1

From Transmission to Transformation — Shifting Teaching Paradigms

Duration	90 minutes
Session Type	Content & Application
Focus Area	Learning theories, paradigm shifts, constructivism, Bloom's Taxonomy, Freire

Learning Objectives

- Trace the shift from behavioral to constructivist and sociocultural approaches in modern education
- Identify the key theoretical figures and frameworks underpinning modern pedagogy (Vygotsky, Piaget, Freire, Bloom)
- Reflect critically on how personal teaching assumptions align with — or depart from — learner-centered philosophy

Content Overview

This opening session sets the philosophical foundation for the entire program. Participants explore how educational paradigms have shifted from the behaviorist "transmission" model — where the teacher pours knowledge into passive learners — to constructivist and sociocultural approaches that position learning as an active, meaning-making process. Paulo Freire's critique of the "banking concept of education" serves as a provocative entry point

into this conversation, inviting teachers to examine not just what they teach, but the assumptions embedded in how they teach.

Drawing on Vygotsky's Zone of Proximal Development, Bloom's revised taxonomy, and cognitivist learning theory, participants examine how major theoretical frameworks translate into concrete classroom practices. The goal is not to discard tradition, but to expand the professional lens — to become more deliberate, theoretically-informed, and intentional about every design decision made in the classroom.

Key Activities

1. "Where Do I Stand?" Teaching Inventory — Participants rate 15 current practices on a learner-centered spectrum; results are discussed in pairs, then shared with the group to map collective starting points
2. Learning Theory Gallery Walk — Six stations each representing a major theory (behaviorism, cognitivism, constructivism, humanism, sociocultural learning, connectivism); participants rotate, annotate with sticky notes, and discuss real-world applications from their own contexts
3. Fishbowl Discussion — A rotating inner circle discusses: "What assumptions are hidden in how you design your lessons?" The outer circle listens and takes notes; groups debrief key insights together

Materials Needed

- Teaching Inventory Worksheet
- Gallery Walk Station Cards (6 sets)
- Sticky notes (3 colors)
- Reflection journals

Reflection Prompt

Describe one moment in your teaching career when you shifted from telling to facilitating. What triggered the shift? What changed for your students — and for you?

SESSION 2

The Learner-Centered Classroom — Principles in Practice

Duration	90 minutes
Session Type	Content & Application
Focus Area	Learner autonomy, voice and choice, Self-Determination Theory, agency in design

Learning Objectives

- Define learner-centered teaching and distinguish it from unstructured or student-led learning

- Identify the five domains of learner-centered practice: environment, curriculum, instruction, assessment, and community
- Redesign one element of an existing lesson using a learner-centered lens

Content Overview

Learner-centered teaching is not a method — it is a philosophical stance. This session draws on the work of Maryellen Weimer (2013) and McCombs and Miller (2007) to unpack what it genuinely means to position the learner as an active agent in their own education. Participants discover that learner-centeredness does not reduce teacher authority; it redirects teacher energy from delivery to design — from performing knowledge to engineering conditions for learning.

Three levers that drive genuine engagement are examined in depth: voice (students have meaningful input in the learning process), choice (students can navigate their learning through multiple pathways), and relevance (content is connected to students' actual lives, goals, and contexts). These levers are examined through Ryan and Deci's Self-Determination Theory and applied directly to the specific teaching contexts participants work in.

Key Activities

1. Classroom Vignette Analysis — Three case studies (primary, secondary, adult/EFL) are analyzed: participants identify learner-centered and teacher-centered elements, then discuss which small shifts would produce the greatest impact on learner experience
2. "Modify It" Workshop — Participants bring one lesson they regularly teach and work in pairs to redesign one element using a learner-centered lens; the modified element is shared and discussed with the whole group
3. 3-V Mapping Activity — Participants map one full lesson against Voice, Choice, and Relevance using a graphic organizer, then identify one immediate improvement for their next class

Materials Needed

- Classroom Vignette Cards (3)
- Modify It Worksheet
- 3-V Mapping Graphic Organizer
- Sample lesson plan

Reflection Prompt

What is one deeply held assumption about your role as a teacher that learner-centered philosophy genuinely challenges? Are you willing to examine it? Why — or why not?

SESSION 3

Knowing Your Learners — Cognitive Diversity and Multiple Intelligences

Duration	90 minutes
Session Type	Content & Application
Focus Area	Gardner's MI Theory, cognitive load, learning profiles, diversity-responsive design

Learning Objectives

- Apply Gardner's Multiple Intelligences framework to expand the range and variety of classroom activity design
- Understand the relationship between cognitive diversity and the need for varied instructional approaches
- Audit an existing lesson for cognitive range and identify gaps in intelligences engaged

Content Overview

No two learners process information the same way. This session introduces Howard Gardner's theory of Multiple Intelligences and explores its practical pedagogical implications. While the scientific debate around MI as a neuroscientific theory continues, its value as a framework for designing varied, inclusive, and intellectually rich tasks is well-established and widely applied across both mainstream and EFL education.

The session also introduces John Sweller's Cognitive Load Theory — helping participants understand how design choices affect working memory and retention. Participants leave with a practical understanding of how to honor cognitive diversity without overwhelming learners, and how to design tasks that engage multiple intelligences without sacrificing depth or rigor.

Key Activities

1. MI Self-Assessment Inventory — Participants complete a Multiple Intelligences profile and reflect on how their dominant intelligences shape their teaching preferences and create blind spots in their lesson design
2. Lesson Audit — Using the MI Coverage Checklist, participants evaluate an existing lesson plan and identify which intelligences are consistently engaged and which are consistently absent
3. "Design for All" Challenge — In groups of three, participants redesign a single assessment task to engage at least four different intelligences, then present and justify their design choices to the group

Materials Needed

- MI Self-Assessment Inventory
- MI Coverage Checklist
- Design for All Template
- Sample lesson plans for audit

Reflection Prompt

Which intelligences do you naturally and consistently design for? Which ones do you rarely engage? What might you be communicating to learners whose strengths lie in those under-represented areas?

SESSION 4

Teacher Identity, Agency and Reflective Practice

Duration	90 minutes
Session Type	Content & Application
Focus Area	Professional identity, Schon's reflective practitioner, growth mindset, the 5R Framework

Learning Objectives

- Articulate the core beliefs and values that form a personal teaching philosophy
- Apply Schon's framework of reflection-in-action and reflection-on-action to professional development
- Establish a structured reflective habit using the 5R Reflection Framework (Bain et al., 2002)

Content Overview

Behind every instructional choice is a set of beliefs — about learners, about knowledge, and about what it means to teach well. This session invites participants to step back from method and into identity: who are you as a teacher, and how do those beliefs shape what your students experience in your classroom? Drawing on Donald Schon's concept of the Reflective Practitioner (1983), participants learn to treat their experience not as something that simply happens to them, but as professional data to be examined, interpreted, and acted upon.

The 5R Reflection Framework (Bain et al., 2002) — Reporting, Responding, Relating, Reasoning, and Reconstructing — provides a structured scaffold for moving beyond surface-level reflection ("the lesson went well") to genuine professional insight ("here is what I now understand differently about how my students learn, and here is what I will do as a result"). Participants establish this as a sustainable weekly practice for the duration of the program and beyond.

Key Activities

1. Teaching Philosophy Draft — A guided 20-minute writing session: participants draft a 150–200 word personal teaching philosophy statement; peer partners offer one observation and one genuine question
2. The Johari Window of Teaching — A self-awareness model adapted for educators helps participants identify known and unknown aspects of their practice; structured small-group discussion follows
3. 5R Protocol Introduction and Application — Trainer models the 5R framework using a real teaching experience (including something that failed), then participants apply it to a recent lesson of their own using the structured template

Materials Needed

- Teaching Philosophy Starter Prompts

- Johari Window for Teachers Worksheet
- 5R Reflection Template
- Reflection Journal

Reflection Prompt

How has your own experience of being taught — the kind of learner you were, the teachers who shaped you — influenced the kind of teacher you have become? What has served you well? What has constrained you?

SESSION 5 · WORKSHOP DAY

WORKSHOP DAY — Micro-Teaching and Peer Observation

Duration	120 minutes
Session Type	Applied Workshop (Formative)
Focus Area	Applied practice, peer feedback, goal setting, consolidation of Week 1

Learning Objectives

- Apply at least one conceptual shift from Week 1 in a live, low-stakes teaching segment
- Give and receive structured peer feedback using the program Observation Checklist (Appendix B)
- Commit to one focused SMART professional goal for the remainder of the program

Workshop Activities

1. Micro-Teaching Rounds — Each participant delivers a 5–7 minute teaching segment while two peers observe using the Observation Checklist; the focus is on evidence of learner-centeredness, not performance quality
2. Glow-Grow-Wonder Debrief — Following each micro-teach, the observer pair delivers structured feedback using the three-part protocol: one strength (Glow), one growth area (Grow), one curiosity or question (Wonder)
3. SMART Goal Setting — Participants identify one teaching strategy from Week 1 and formalize their commitment to developing it across the program using the SMART Goal Template; goals are shared in pairs for accountability

Materials Needed

- Observation Checklist (Appendix B)
- Glow-Grow-Wonder Feedback Card
- SMART Goal Template
- Reflection Journal

TRAINER NOTE

This is a formative, psychologically safe session. Create the conditions for risk-taking by sharing a personal micro-teaching moment of your own — including what did not go as planned. Assessment is based on participation and willingness to experiment, not performance quality. The Observation Checklist is a tool for professional dialogue, not evaluation.

Reflection Prompt

What did you notice about your own teaching during the micro-teach that your self-assessment had not revealed before? What did your peer's observation tell you that you could not see from the inside?

WEEK 2 — DIFFERENTIATION, ACCOMMODATION & INCLUSION

Designing proactively for every learner in the room

Week Overview

Week 2 moves from understanding who learners are to designing instruction that genuinely serves all of them. Differentiation, accommodation, and Universal Design for Learning are introduced not as compliance frameworks or special education concerns, but as core competencies of excellent teaching. By the end of the week, participants will have designed a fully differentiated lesson they can use in their actual classroom.

Week Learning Objectives

- Define and apply Tomlinson's DI model across content, process, product, environment, and affect
- Design tiered tasks, choice boards, and learning profile menus for real teaching contexts
- Accurately distinguish accommodation from modification and apply scaffolding with intentionality
- Apply UDL guidelines to build proactively inclusive lessons across all three principles

SESSION 6

Understanding Differentiation — The Tomlinson Framework

Duration	90 minutes
Session Type	Content & Application
Focus Area	DI theory, readiness/interest/profile, equity vs. equality, Tomlinson's 5 elements

Learning Objectives

- Define differentiated instruction and distinguish it from tracking, remediation, or lowering expectations
- Apply Tomlinson's DI model: differentiating content, process, product, environment, and affect
- Identify the three learner variables that drive differentiation: readiness, interest, and learning profile

Content Overview

Carol Ann Tomlinson's model of Differentiated Instruction remains one of the most teacher-applicable frameworks in modern pedagogy. At its core, DI challenges the myth of the "average" learner — the invisible standard against which all students are implicitly measured.

In a differentiated classroom, the teacher proactively designs multiple pathways to the same rigorous learning outcomes, based on who the learners actually are rather than who we imagine them to be.

This session builds the conceptual foundation for the week by establishing a critical distinction between equality and equity: equality gives everyone the same thing, while equity gives each person what they need to access the same high-quality outcome. This distinction transforms how teachers think about differentiation — not as giving some students less, but as removing unnecessary barriers while maintaining uncompromising rigor.

Key Activities

1. **DI Myth-Busting Exercise** — Participants respond to 10 common misconceptions about differentiation using voting cards (Agree / Disagree / It depends); each misconception is debriefed with evidence-based clarification and discussion
2. **The DI Matrix** — Using a structured table mapping student variables (readiness, interest, learning profile) against the five DI elements, participants populate the matrix with examples from their own teaching context
3. **Classroom Video Analysis** — A footage segment or trainer-modeled demonstration of DI in action; participants annotate using the DI Matrix and discuss: "What was differentiated? For whom? Why did it matter?"

Materials Needed

- DI Myth-Busting Cards (10)
- DI Matrix Worksheet
- Video clip or trainer demonstration materials
- Reflection Journal

Reflection Prompt

Think of one student who has consistently struggled in your class. Through Tomlinson's framework, which element — content, process, product, environment, or affect — might have made the biggest difference for them? What stopped you from changing it?

SESSION 7

Differentiation in Practice — Tiers, Choice Boards and Learning Profiles

Duration	90 minutes
Session Type	Content & Application
Focus Area	Tiered instruction, choice boards, flexible grouping, practical DI design

Learning Objectives

- Design at least two tiered versions of a single task at different levels of cognitive complexity
- Create a choice board that honors student interest while maintaining a shared learning goal
- Apply flexible grouping principles based on readiness, interest, or learning profile

Content Overview

This session moves decisively from theory to design. Three concrete DI strategies form the practical core of the day: tiered instruction (same concept, different cognitive complexity — not simply "easier" or "harder"), choice boards (same learning outcome, different pathway or product), and learning profile menus (same goal, different modality or processing approach). Participants develop each of these tools for lessons they actually teach.

In EFL and EAL contexts, differentiation carries an additional layer of complexity: language proficiency intersects with content readiness in ways that require careful, responsive design. The session addresses how to differentiate without inadvertently lowering language expectations — scaffolding access while maintaining both cognitive and linguistic rigor. The key is never to confuse a language barrier with a learning limitation.

Key Activities

1. Tiered Task Workshop — Given a shared learning objective, participants create three versions of the same task at varying levels of cognitive complexity (not difficulty), using Bloom's Taxonomy as the scaffold for designing upward complexity rather than downward simplification
2. Choice Board Design Sprint — Participants design a 3×3 or 2×4 choice board for an upcoming unit; every cell must target the same essential learning goal while offering different pathways, products, or modes of engagement
3. Flexible Grouping Practice — Using three anonymized class profiles, participants sort students into flexible groups using three different criteria (readiness, interest, learning profile) and discuss how each grouping changes the instructional approach

Materials Needed

- Task Complexity Scale
- Choice Board Template
- Flexible Grouping Cards
- Bloom's Taxonomy Reference

Reflection Prompt

How will you communicate the purpose of differentiation to your students so that it feels fair and inclusive rather than labeling or hierarchical? What language will you use? What questions do you anticipate from them?

SESSION 8

Accommodation, Modification and Scaffolding — Supporting Every Learner

Duration	90 minutes
Session Type	Content & Application
Focus Area	Accommodation vs. modification, Bruner's scaffolding, gradual release, ELL-inclusive practice

Learning Objectives

- Accurately distinguish between accommodation and modification and apply each appropriately in lesson design
- Design a scaffolding sequence for a cognitively demanding task using the gradual release model
- Identify practical accommodation strategies for common learning differences including ELL profiles

Content Overview

Accommodation changes how a learner accesses content or demonstrates knowledge — without altering the learning goals. Modification changes the goals themselves. This is one of the most critical and most frequently confused distinctions in inclusive education. Over-modifying for a learner who simply needs better scaffolding caps potential and communicates low expectations. Under-accommodating a learner who needs structural support produces frustration, disengagement, and avoidable failure.

Jerome Bruner's concept of scaffolding — temporary, calibrated support that enables a learner to accomplish something they could not yet do independently — is introduced as the connective tissue between accommodation and rigorous instruction. Scaffolding is not permanent; it is designed to be progressively withdrawn as learner capacity grows. Participants map scaffolding sequences using the Gradual Release model (I Do — We Do — You Do — You Do Independently), specifying both the support provided and the condition for its removal.

Key Activities

1. Case File Review — Five anonymized student profiles (ELL learners at different proficiency levels, a student with ADHD, and a highly capable learner with processing differences) are presented; in small groups, participants propose targeted accommodation and scaffolding strategies for each case
2. Accommodation vs. Modification Sort — Twenty instructional adjustments are presented on cards; participants categorize each as accommodation, modification, or scaffolding and justify their reasoning; ambiguous cases generate productive discussion
3. Scaffolding Ladder Design — Using a graphic organizer, participants map the scaffolding supports for one high-demand task across four stages of gradual release, specifying how and when each support will be faded

Materials Needed

- Case File Cards (5 profiles)
- Sort Cards (20)
- Scaffolding Ladder Template
- Gradual Release Model Reference

Reflection Prompt

Where in your current teaching are you unintentionally modifying — reducing expectations — when the learner actually needs better scaffolding — a higher-quality support structure? What is the cost of that confusion for the learner's long-term growth?

SESSION 9**Universal Design for Learning — Designing for All from the Start**

Duration	90 minutes
Session Type	Content & Application
Focus Area	UDL's 3 principles, CAST guidelines, proactive vs. reactive inclusion, variability as the norm

Learning Objectives

- Explain the three UDL principles and distinguish proactive (UDL) design from reactive (accommodation) inclusion
- Apply at least two UDL guidelines from each principle to an existing lesson
- Articulate the relationship between UDL, cognitive neuroscience, and equitable educational outcomes

Content Overview

Universal Design for Learning reframes the fundamental question of inclusive education. Instead of asking "How do we fix this student?" it asks "How do we fix this lesson?" Drawing on the CAST framework and the neuroscience of learning variability, UDL asks educators to design flexible learning environments that anticipate diversity rather than treating it as an exception requiring special intervention. When environments are built for the widest range of learners from the outset, every learner — not just those with identified needs — benefits.

The three UDL principles — Multiple Means of Representation (the what of learning), Action and Expression (the how), and Engagement (the why) — map onto three neural networks. Each principle encompasses concrete guidelines that translate neuroscience into classroom practice. This session applies those guidelines in realistic instructional contexts, with emphasis on what teachers can do next week rather than what they might do someday with more resources.

Key Activities

1. UDL Audit — Using a simplified version of the CAST UDL Guidelines (v3.0), participants audit their last three lessons and identify patterns across the three principles; findings are shared in pairs with a focus on priorities, not deficiencies
2. UDL Redesign Sprint — Working in pairs, participants select one lesson and apply at least one guideline from each of the three UDL principles; each design decision is annotated with the specific guideline number and rationale
3. Gallery Walk with Sticky Note Enhancement — Pairs post their redesigned lessons; participants circulate and leave "Add-a-Guideline" suggestions on sticky notes identifying one additional UDL enhancement the design team might not have noticed

Materials Needed

- UDL Guidelines Reference Card (CAST v3.0, simplified)
- UDL Audit Worksheet
- UDL Redesign Template
- Sticky notes (2 colors)

Reflection Prompt

What is one structural barrier in your current curriculum, physical environment, or assessment practice that UDL could help you dismantle proactively — before a student needs to struggle or ask for help?

SESSION 10 · WORKSHOP DAY

WORKSHOP DAY — Designing the Differentiated Lesson

Duration	120 minutes
Session Type	Applied Workshop (Formative)
Focus Area	Integrated application of DI, accommodation, and UDL in a complete lesson design

Learning Objectives

- Design a complete lesson integrating tiered tasks, at least one accommodation strategy, and UDL-guided features across all three principles
- Articulate and defend design choices using the theoretical frameworks from Week 2
- Provide and receive structured peer feedback using the Differentiated Lesson Design Rubric

Workshop Activities

1. Differentiated Lesson Design Sprint — Participants have 45 minutes to design a complete 45–60 minute lesson including: tiered tasks at two or more levels of complexity, at least one accommodation strategy for a named learner need, and at least three UDL guidelines represented across the three principles

2. Peer Review with DI Lesson Rubric — Pairs exchange designs and apply the four-criterion rubric (Objective Alignment, Differentiation Range, UDL Integration, Practical Feasibility), providing written feedback in each category with specific examples
3. Gallery Share and Trainer Feedback — Three to four volunteers share designs with the whole group; the trainer highlights exemplary differentiation moves and facilitates discussion of the tradeoffs and design decisions behind them

Materials Needed

- DI Lesson Design Template
- DI Lesson Rubric (4 criteria)
- UDL Guidelines Reference Card
- Peer Feedback Form

TRAINER NOTE

Circulate actively during the design sprint and provide targeted coaching. Prioritize feasibility: the goal is a lesson participants can realistically use next week, not a theoretical masterpiece. Coach them to make explicit choices and be able to explain "why this strategy, for this learner need" for every differentiation decision.

Reflection Prompt

Looking at the lesson you designed today — honestly: which parts would you actually use next week? What would you need to make the rest more implementable in your real classroom context?

WEEK 3 — ACTIVE LEARNING & ENGAGEMENT STRATEGIES

Moving from passive reception to active construction of knowledge

Week Overview

Week 3 builds the practical repertoire that teachers need to design genuinely engaging classrooms. Each strategy introduced — Project-Based Learning, cooperative structures, active learning design, and technology integration — is grounded in cognitive science and applied through hands-on practice. The week culminates in live facilitation of an active learning segment, connecting theory to teaching behavior.

Week Learning Objectives

- Distinguish passive, interactive, and fully active learning and evaluate the research basis for each
- Design a PBL unit blueprint with a compelling driving question and a public product
- Facilitate at least three cooperative learning structures with fidelity and intentionality
- Apply the SAMR model to integrate technology in ways that genuinely enhance — not just replace — instruction

SESSION 11

From Passive to Active — The Science of Engagement

Duration	90 minutes
Session Type	Content & Application
Focus Area	Active learning research, the AER cycle, cognitive demand, flow theory

Learning Objectives

- Understand the cognitive and motivational science underpinning active learning, including Csikszentmihalyi's flow theory and Freeman et al. (2014)
- Distinguish between passive, interactive, and fully active learning structures and evaluate when each is appropriate
- Identify activation points in an existing lesson and redesign them to increase cognitive engagement

Content Overview

Research is unambiguous: students learn more, retain more, and transfer knowledge more effectively when they are actively engaged. Freeman et al. (2014) found that students in active learning environments outperformed those in traditional lectures by 1.5 grade points on average, and were significantly less likely to fail. Marzano identifies high engagement as one of the most powerful predictors of academic achievement. This session builds the

research-backed case for redesigning instruction around active participation — not as a trend, but as an evidence-based professional responsibility.

But engagement is not mere activity. A student can be physically busy and cognitively passive. True engagement requires that learners are cognitively challenged, emotionally invested, and constructing — not merely consuming — meaning. The Activity-Experience-Reflection (AER) cycle provides a practical framework for designing learning sequences that move learners from doing to understanding to applying, creating the conditions for durable, transferable learning.

Key Activities

1. Lesson Engagement Audit — Participants chart the cognitive demand level and student activity level of each segment in one of their typical lessons; the resulting visual often reveals striking patterns that self-reporting alone does not surface
2. "Passive to Active" Rewrite — Given a 45-minute traditional lecture plan, participants identify three activation points and redesign each segment using an active learning structure from a provided menu; redesigned segments are shared and discussed
3. Active Learning Spectrum Sort — Twenty common classroom activities are sorted on a spectrum from fully passive to fully active; the sorting process generates productive debate about what "active" actually means in different contexts

Materials Needed

- Engagement Audit Template
- Passive-to-Active Rewrite Worksheet
- Activity Cards (20)
- Active Learning Spectrum Poster

Reflection Prompt

What fears or practical resistances do you have around increasing active learning? Name them honestly. Now: what is the smallest possible first step you could take in your next lesson to move in that direction?

SESSION 12

Project-Based Learning — Design and Implementation

Duration	90 minutes
Session Type	Content & Application
Focus Area	Gold Standard PBL, driving questions, authenticity, student voice, EFL adaptations

Learning Objectives

- Define Project-Based Learning and distinguish it rigorously from end-of-unit projects
- Identify all seven elements of Gold Standard PBL (Buck Institute for Education)
- Draft a PBL unit blueprint including a driving question, authentic context, and public product

Content Overview

Project-Based Learning is not simply assigning a project. True PBL is organized around a challenging, authentic problem or question requiring sustained inquiry over time. It gives students genuine voice and choice, requires them to build knowledge iteratively, and culminates in a public product that matters beyond the classroom. The Buck Institute for Education's Gold Standard framework identifies seven essential elements: a challenging problem or question, sustained inquiry, authenticity, student voice and choice, reflection, critique and revision, and a public product.

In EFL and language learning contexts, PBL offers powerful affordances: authentic communicative purpose, language used for genuine meaning-making, and intrinsic motivation through relevance. The session also addresses practical PBL challenges — timeline management, assessing individual contribution within group work, differentiation within the project structure, and maintaining content and language rigor when students have significant agency.

Key Activities

1. PBL vs. Project Comparison — Participants analyze four instructional examples using the Gold Standard checklist to determine whether each meets PBL criteria; disagreements are productive and lead to deeper understanding of each element
2. Driving Question Workshop — Participants write and refine driving questions using the "How do we...?" framework, evaluated against four criteria: challenging, open-ended, authentic, and curriculum-aligned; questions are improved through structured peer feedback
3. PBL Unit Blueprint — Using the provided template, participants draft the skeleton of a PBL unit relevant to their context, including driving question, knowledge and skills students will build, authentic context, and product type; drafts are shared with a partner for initial feedback

Materials Needed

- Gold Standard PBL Checklist
- Driving Question Craft Guide
- PBL Unit Blueprint Template
- Example PBL Units (2–3 from diverse contexts)

Reflection Prompt

What would your students need from you to successfully navigate a PBL unit? What structures and freedoms would they need? And what would you need to let go of to make it possible?

SESSION 13

Cooperative and Collaborative Learning — Structures That Work

Duration	90 minutes
Session Type	Content & Application
Focus Area	Kagan structures, Johnson & Johnson's 5 elements, cooperative design, EFL applications

Learning Objectives

- Distinguish cooperative learning from unstructured group work and articulate why the distinction matters for learning outcomes
- Facilitate at least three cooperative structures with accuracy: Jigsaw, Think-Pair-Share, Numbered Heads Together, and Carousel Brainstorm
- Design a cooperative task that builds content knowledge, language production, and social skills simultaneously

Content Overview

Cooperative learning is not group work. Unstructured group work too often results in unequal participation — more capable students doing the work while others observe or comply. Cooperative learning, by contrast, is designed for positive interdependence (each member's contribution is genuinely necessary) and individual accountability (each person must demonstrate their own learning). Spencer Kagan's structures and Johnson and Johnson's five essential elements (positive interdependence, individual accountability, promotive interaction, collaborative skills, and group processing) transform ordinary group tasks into structured cooperation.

For EFL learners in particular, cooperative structures create exceptionally valuable conditions: multiple opportunities for authentic interaction, lower affective filter through peer-to-peer communication, and integrated practice of both receptive and productive language skills in a socially supported, low-threat environment. The session addresses how to structure cooperative learning so that language development, not just task completion, is the explicit goal.

Key Activities

1. Live Jigsaw Experience — Participants become experts on a cooperative learning structure (one structure per expert group), then reconvene in mixed groups to teach their peers; participants experience both expert-learner and peer-teacher roles within the Jigsaw itself
2. Structure Lab — In rapid rotation, participants practice Numbered Heads Together, Carousel Brainstorm, and Inside-Outside Circle using actual curriculum content; after each structure, they annotate a "What I noticed / What I would change" card
3. Cooperative Task Design — Using Johnson and Johnson's five elements as a design checklist, participants design one complete cooperative task for an upcoming lesson, specifying the interdependence structure, individual accountability method, and group processing protocol

Materials Needed

- Jigsaw Expert Cards (4 topics)
- Structure Lab Station Instructions
- Cooperative Task Design Template
- Johnson & Johnson Reference Card

Reflection Prompt

Which cooperative structure felt most natural to facilitate? Which one challenged you — and which challenged your learners? What does that asymmetry reveal about your current instructional defaults?

SESSION 14**Technology-Enhanced Learning and the Flipped Classroom**

Duration	90 minutes
Session Type	Content & Application
Focus Area	SAMR model, flipped learning design, digital tool selection, technology as pedagogy not decoration

Learning Objectives

- Apply the SAMR model (Puentedura) to evaluate current technology use and identify one upgrade path
- Design a complete flipped classroom model for one lesson, including a pre-class activity and a redesigned in-class session
- Select digital tools for specific instructional goals using a principled selection framework

Content Overview

Technology is not the strategy — it is the vehicle. The question is never "Should I use technology?" but rather "Does this technology serve this learning goal, for these learners, in this moment, better than the alternative?" Ruben Puentedura's SAMR model (Substitution, Augmentation, Modification, Redefinition) provides a practical taxonomy for evaluating the depth of technology integration. The goal is not always to reach Redefinition, but to be intentional and evidence-informed about which level genuinely serves the learning.

The Flipped Classroom model — where direct instruction is delivered asynchronously outside class time, freeing face-to-face time for active, collaborative, and higher-order engagement — is examined in depth. Participants design both components of the flip: a high-quality pre-class activity and a correspondingly high-value in-class session that would not be possible without the flipped structure. Emphasis is placed on the "why" of flipping, not just the mechanics.

Key Activities

1. SAMR Audit — Participants chart their current technology uses on the SAMR matrix; patterns are discussed and one priority area for upgrading by one level is identified in pairs with a concrete plan for implementation
2. "Flip It!" Design Workshop — Participants select a content-heavy segment of a current lesson, design a pre-class alternative (video, podcast, annotated reading, or digital interactive), and redesign the face-to-face time for maximum active engagement
3. Digital Tool Matchmaking — Participants receive a set of 16 digital tool cards and 12 instructional goal scenario cards; they match tools to goals, evaluate the quality of each match, and discuss reasoning with the group

Materials Needed

- SAMR Audit Matrix
- Flipped Lesson Design Template
- Digital Tool Card Deck (16)
- Instructional Goal Scenario Cards (12)

Reflection Prompt

Where is your current technology use on the SAMR scale — honestly? What would moving up one level look like for one specific lesson you teach regularly? What is the actual barrier preventing you from doing it now?

SESSION 15 · WORKSHOP DAY

WORKSHOP DAY — Live Active Learning Demonstration

Duration	120 minutes
Session Type	Applied Workshop (Formative)
Focus Area	Live facilitation, peer feedback with 3-lens protocol, facilitation self-assessment

Learning Objectives

- Facilitate a 10-minute learning segment using at least one active learning strategy from Week 3
- Respond to peer feedback with a specific, actionable reflection rather than defense or deflection
- Identify one concrete refinement and articulate how it would change the learner's experience

Workshop Activities

1. Active Learning Demonstrations — Each participant facilitates a 10-minute segment using a strategy from this week (PBL driving question session, cooperative structure,

flipped activity, or other active strategy); the trainer tracks design elements rather than evaluating performance

2. 3-Lens Peer Feedback — Observers use three lenses: Engagement (were learners genuinely cognitively active?), Clarity (were instructions clear enough for learners to self-direct?), and Agency (did learners have meaningful choice at any point?)
3. Facilitation Self-Assessment — After receiving feedback, each participant completes the self-assessment comparing intended design to actual experience, identifying one specific refinement and explaining how it would change what learners experience in the next iteration

Materials Needed

- 3-Lens Peer Feedback Form
- Facilitation Self-Assessment Template
- Active Learning Strategy Menu (reference)
- Reflection Journal

TRAINER NOTE

Frame this session explicitly as an experiment, not a performance. Model the growth mindset you are asking participants to inhabit: name something in your own facilitation this week that you are actively refining. Normalize productive failure as the primary mechanism of professional learning.

Reflection Prompt

What did you notice happening in the room — with energy, attention, and interaction — when you used the active learning strategy? How does that compare to what typically happens in a more teacher-directed lesson?

WEEK 4 — ASSESSMENT, FEEDBACK & REFLECTIVE PRACTICE

Closing the loop between learning and evidence

Week Overview

Week 4 addresses the dimensions of teaching that most directly reveal whether learning is actually occurring: how we assess, how we use assessment data, and how we respond to what we find. By the end of the week, participants will have built a coherent assessment philosophy, a formative toolkit, a summative design, and a growth-driving feedback protocol — and will commit to a classroom action research inquiry to sustain their professional development after the program ends.

Week Learning Objectives

- Distinguish assessment FOR, AS, and OF learning and design each type with clarity of purpose
- Build a repertoire of formative assessment strategies and use evidence to make real-time instructional decisions
- Design a valid, criterion-referenced summative assessment with a calibrated analytic rubric
- Write feedback that is specific, descriptive, actionable, and calibrated to the learner's readiness level

SESSION 16

Assessment Literacy — Understanding Assessment in the Modern Classroom

Duration	90 minutes
Session Type	Content & Application
Focus Area	Assessment FOR/AS/OF learning, validity & reliability, alignment, Black & Wiliam (1998)

Learning Objectives

- Distinguish assessment FOR, AS, and OF learning and explain the unique purpose and timing of each
- Evaluate an existing assessment for validity, reliability, and fairness using a structured analysis framework
- Articulate an assessment philosophy coherent with the learner-centered stance developed throughout this program

Content Overview

Assessment is not a measurement of learning that happens after teaching is complete. It is part of learning — woven through every lesson, informing every instructional decision, and communicating to learners what is valued in the educational environment. This session challenges the assessment-as-endpoint paradigm by building a broader, more dynamic model of assessment literacy. Drawing on Black and Wiliam's landmark 1998 synthesis on formative assessment and Dylan Wiliam's subsequent work on embedded formative practice, participants develop a conceptual architecture for principled assessment design.

Three modes of assessment are examined: Assessment FOR Learning (formative — giving teachers real-time information to adjust instruction), Assessment AS Learning (self and peer assessment — developing metacognitive awareness in learners), and Assessment OF Learning (summative — documenting achievement at the close of a learning cycle). A healthy assessment ecosystem integrates all three modes, carefully balanced and purposefully aligned to what learners are actually being asked to develop.

Key Activities

1. Assessment Philosophy Audit — Participants respond to eight prompts about their current assessment practice and score themselves on coherence; results are shared in small groups with a focus on identifying gaps between espoused values and actual practice
2. Assessment Type Sort — Twelve assessment examples are sorted into FOR, AS, and OF learning categories; ambiguous cases generate rich discussion about purpose, timing, and design intent
3. Alignment Check — Given three sample assessments and one unit learning objective, participants evaluate the degree of alignment and redesign the weakest-aligned assessment to improve its validity and relevance

Materials Needed

- Assessment Philosophy Audit Instrument
- Assessment Sort Cards (12)
- Alignment Check Worksheet
- Black & Wiliam Summary (1-page)

Reflection Prompt

In your current practice, which assessment mode dominates — FOR, AS, or OF learning? What does that imbalance cost your students? What would a more balanced, coherent assessment ecology look like in your specific context?

SESSION 17

Formative Assessment Strategies — Real-Time Data for Learning

Duration	90 minutes
Session Type	Content & Application
Focus Area	FA techniques, exit tickets, data-driven decisions, responsive teaching, actionable evidence

Learning Objectives

- Demonstrate command of at least six formative assessment strategies and explain the specific diagnostic information each yields
- Interpret a set of classroom evidence from a formative check and make a specific, evidence-based instructional decision
- Design an exit ticket sequence for a complete unit, with each ticket directly aligned to a session objective

Content Overview

Formative assessment is the cornerstone of responsive teaching. When teachers have real-time information about what students understand — and what they do not — they can adapt immediately: slowing down, reteaching, extending, or reconstituting groups. The challenge is not knowing that formative assessment matters; it is designing and using strategies that yield genuinely actionable evidence rather than superficial compliance indicators. This session builds a practical repertoire with emphasis on high-yield, low-preparation strategies that function across diverse teaching contexts.

Equally important is what happens next: what teachers actually do with formative data once they have it. Formative assessment that does not change instruction is just another kind of testing. This session deliberately includes practice in data interpretation and instructional decision-making: given this evidence of understanding (or misunderstanding), what specifically should happen in the next ten minutes?

Key Activities

1. FA Strategy Carousel — Six stations, each featuring one formative strategy (Exit Ticket, Traffic Lights, KWL Chart, Whiteboard Response, Think-Aloud Protocol, Digital Poll); participants experience each from the learner's perspective and annotate: "What does this tell the teacher? What does it not tell the teacher?"
2. Exit Ticket Design Workshop — Participants design a five-session exit ticket sequence for one upcoming unit, with each ticket directly aligned to a specific session objective; tickets are shared and refined for specificity and actionability
3. "What Do I Do Now?" Data Interpretation — The trainer presents sample class data from a fictional exit ticket response set; participants analyze patterns and propose specific next instructional moves, justifying each decision with reference to the formative evidence

Materials Needed

- FA Strategy Carousel Station Cards
- Exit Ticket Design Template
- Class Data Sample Set
- "Next Move" Decision Framework

Reflection Prompt

When you discover — through a formative check — that students have not understood something you just taught, what do you typically do next? Is your response driven by the evidence — or by the lesson plan? What would it take to make evidence the driver?

SESSION 18**Summative Assessment Design and Rubrics — Beyond the Test**

Duration	90 minutes
Session Type	Content & Application
Focus Area	Performance-based assessment, backward design, rubric construction, calibration, portfolio assessment

Learning Objectives

- Design a summative assessment that reflects authentic, real-world performance rather than isolated content recall
- Construct a valid, criterion-referenced analytic rubric with at least three criteria and four performance levels
- Apply backward design principles to ensure alignment across learning objectives, instruction, and assessment

Content Overview

Summative assessments should reflect what learning actually looks like in the world beyond the classroom — not what students can recall under timed, decontextualized conditions. This session introduces performance-based assessment, portfolio assessment, and alternative summative formats as rigorous, valid alternatives to traditional testing. The underlying argument is not that traditional tests are inherently bad, but that they are often not the most valid or the most meaningful way to evaluate the competencies teachers are actually developing in their students.

The centerpiece practical skill of this session is rubric design. A well-constructed rubric accomplishes three things: it communicates expectations with precision before the task begins, it enables consistent and fair evaluation during marking, and it provides specific, descriptive feedback learners can actually use to improve. Participants learn the difference between holistic and analytic rubrics, practice writing criterion-referenced performance level descriptors, and calibrate their rubrics against sample student work to ensure shared understanding.

Key Activities

1. **Alternative Assessment Gallery** — Participants examine six examples of non-traditional summative assessments from diverse contexts (science exhibition, digital portfolio, podcast, structured debate, performance task, learning journey map); for each, they identify the learning objectives assessed, the evidence of validity, and the design principles at work
2. **Rubric Writing Workshop** — Participants select one performance task and draft a complete analytic rubric with three to five criteria, four performance levels each, and descriptive (not merely evaluative) language in every cell; a common rubric error guide is used for self-checking
3. **Peer Calibration Exercise** — Pairs swap rubrics and apply them independently to the same sample student work; discrepancies in scoring are discussed and rubric language is refined until shared understanding and consistent application are achieved

Materials Needed

- Alternative Assessment Gallery Cards (6)
- Rubric Design Template
- Rubric Language Guide (Do / Don't)
- Sample Student Work for Calibration

Reflection Prompt

How often do your students know exactly what "excellent" looks like before they begin an assessed task? How would providing a rubric before — not after — the task change how they approach the work, and what they actually produce?

SESSION 19

Feedback That Drives Growth — From Evaluation to Dialogue

Duration	90 minutes
Session Type	Content & Application
Focus Area	Hattie & Timperley (2007), descriptive feedback, peer feedback protocols, EFL affective context

Learning Objectives

- Apply Hattie and Timperley's four-level feedback model to evaluate the quality and impact of existing teacher feedback practices
- Rewrite evaluative, vague, or demotivating feedback as descriptive, level-appropriate, growth-oriented responses
- Design a peer feedback protocol that builds learner capacity for self-regulation and metacognition

Content Overview

John Hattie and Helen Timperley's 2007 meta-synthesis identified feedback as one of the most powerful influences on student achievement — with an effect size nearly double the average educational intervention. But the quality of feedback matters enormously. Feedback is most effective when it is specific (not "great work"), timely (not weeks after submission), actionable (giving the learner something concrete to do with it), and calibrated to the right level — task, process, self-regulation, or self.

In EFL and multilingual contexts, feedback is complicated by an additional affective dimension: learners whose sense of competence and identity is bound up in their language proficiency may experience corrective or evaluative feedback very differently than a learner receiving content feedback in their first language. This session addresses feedback in language-rich and emotionally sensitive contexts, with specific attention to reformulation, error correction approaches, and the balance between accuracy-focused and fluency-focused feedback.

Key Activities

1. Feedback Audit — Participants review five examples of written teacher feedback on student work and evaluate each using Hattie's four-level model; they score each piece on specificity, actionability, and likely learner impact
2. "Rewrite the Feedback" Workshop — Given eight examples of vague, evaluative, or potentially demotivating teacher feedback, participants rewrite each one as a descriptive, growth-oriented, actionable response calibrated to the appropriate Hattie level
3. Peer Feedback Protocol Design — Participants design a structured peer feedback activity for their own classroom, specifying: the feedback protocol (e.g., Two Stars and a Wish, I Notice / I Wonder), sentence stems for learners, and the self-assessment component that follows

Materials Needed

- Feedback Sample Set (5 pieces)
- Feedback Rewrite Cards (8)
- Peer Feedback Protocol Template
- Hattie's Four-Level Model Reference

Reflection Prompt

Think of a piece of feedback you received as a learner — from a teacher, a mentor, or a colleague — that genuinely changed how you did something. What made it powerful? What specifically about that feedback can you replicate in your own practice?

SESSION 20 · CAPSTONE

CAPSTONE SESSION — Action Research and Program Synthesis

Duration	150 minutes
Session Type	Summative Capstone
Focus Area	Action research design, PDSA cycle, program synthesis, professional commitment, celebration

Learning Objectives

- Design a short-cycle classroom Action Research inquiry rooted in a genuine question that emerged during the program
- Synthesize key learning across all four weeks into a coherent, actionable personal development plan
- Share a Teaching Transformation Commitment with the learning community

Capstone Activities

1. Action Research Design Workshop — Using the PDSA (Plan-Do-Study-Act) inquiry cycle, participants design a 4–6 week classroom inquiry around one authentic question about student learning that surfaced during the program; designs specify: the inquiry question, the evidence to be collected, the instructional change to be implemented, and the criterion for judging success
2. Program Synthesis: Looking Back, Moving Forward — Participants complete a visual synthesis artifact mapping their key conceptual shifts, the strategies they are committing to implement in the next term, and the one belief about teaching or learning that has genuinely changed for them
3. Teaching Transformation Commitment Circle — Each participant shares one concrete commitment: what they will do differently, how they will know it is working, and when they will check in with themselves and their peer accountability partner; commitments are displayed on a shared wall

Materials Needed

- PDSA Action Research Template
- Program Synthesis Visual Template
- Certificate of Completion
- Accountability Partnership Cards

TRAINER NOTE

This is a celebration session. Prepare Certificates of Completion. Create a physical or digital "Commitment Wall" for participants to photograph and revisit. The closing circle is the most important 20 minutes of the program — protect it. Each participant should leave having named something that has genuinely shifted, articulated a commitment they believe in, and felt genuinely acknowledged by the learning community they have built together over four weeks.

Reflection Prompt

When you return to your classroom next week, what will your students notice is different about you? Not the strategies — the orientation. The stance. The belief. What has genuinely shifted in how you see learning and your role in creating it?

Hands-On Activities Bank

The following activities are designed for direct use in training sessions. Each activity has been designed to build both conceptual understanding and practical fluency. Trainers may substitute these for the session activities listed in the weekly plans or use them as extension options for groups that work through planned activities quickly.

ACTIVITY NAME	TYPE	TIME	GROUP SIZE	DESCRIPTION & PURPOSE
The Teaching Philosophy Gallery	Reflective Practice	45–60 min	Individual then group	Participants write a 100-word teaching philosophy, post it on the wall, and take a gallery walk reading peers' philosophies. They leave one sticky note comment on three different philosophies. Debrief centers on recurring themes and meaningful differences. <i>Purpose: Surfaces beliefs, builds community, creates a baseline document for comparison at program end.</i>
The Jigsaw Deep Dive	Cooperative Learning	60–90 min	Groups of 4–6	Divide complex reading or content into four sections. Expert groups master one section, then teach it to their home group. Each section contributes to a whole-group synthesis task that requires all four parts. <i>Purpose: Builds both individual accountability and positive interdependence; models the Jigsaw structure for direct classroom adoption.</i>
Differentiated Text Sets	Differentiation / Accommodation	30–45 min	Individual or pairs	Provide three versions of the same informational text — original, simplified, and enriched — on the same topic. Participants read the version matched to a student profile and complete a shared comprehension task. Debrief: what is the same? What is different? What does this say about scaffold design? <i>Purpose: Makes differentiation concrete; shifts thinking from "giving less" to "calibrating access."</i>
The Driving Question Studio	Project-Based Learning	30–45 min	Pairs or small groups	Participants receive a topic, a year level, and a subject. They generate five driving questions, then rank them against four PBL criteria (open-ended, challenging, authentic, curriculum-aligned). The group's best question is

				submitted for whole-group ranking and discussion. <i>Purpose: Builds the most difficult PBL skill: crafting questions that are genuinely open and genuinely connected to standards.</i>
Exit Ticket Lab	Formative Assessment	20–30 min	Individual then pairs	The trainer delivers a short 10-minute input session on a topic participants do not know well. Participants then design three exit ticket options for that session. Pairs compare: which ticket would yield the most actionable data? Why? What would each tell the teacher — and what would it miss? <i>Purpose: Teaches exit ticket design through experiential learning; develops assessment-as-information thinking.</i>
The Feedback Rewrite Station	Feedback & Assessment	30–40 min	Individual then group	Participants receive ten examples of written teacher feedback. Using a provided rubric (specificity, actionability, level-appropriateness), they score each sample and then rewrite the three lowest-scoring examples. Rewrites are shared and discussed for patterns. <i>Purpose: Develops precision in feedback language; makes the abstract quality of "good feedback" concrete and replicable.</i>
UDL Lesson Redesign Sprint	Universal Design for Learning	45–60 min	Pairs	Pairs select one lesson from their current curriculum and apply the UDL Redesign Protocol: they must add at least one guideline from each of the three UDL principles. Time constraint is a design feature: it forces prioritization rather than perfection. <i>Purpose: Makes UDL immediately practical; the time limit prevents over-engineering and keeps focus on "what can I do next week?"</i>
The Active Learning Makeover	Active Learning	45 min	Small groups of 3	Groups receive a traditional 45-minute lesson plan and a menu of active learning structures. They redesign the lesson using at least three different active structures. Each redesign is presented to the group with a rationale explaining what makes each element genuinely active rather than

				merely interactive. <i>Purpose: Builds fluency in identifying and applying active learning structures; develops design reasoning.</i>
Cooperative Jigsaw with Structures	Cooperative Learning	60–75 min	Groups of 4	Four cooperative structures are distributed as expert topics. Expert groups master one structure and prepare a 5-minute live demonstration. They then reconvene in mixed groups and teach their structure. The final task requires each group to design a lesson using all four structures — one per phase of the learning cycle. <i>Purpose: Builds repertoire and fluency through experience; connects structures to lesson design sequence.</i>
The Scaffold and Release Map	Accommodation / Scaffolding	30–45 min	Individual then pairs	Given one complex task and one learner profile, participants map a complete scaffolding sequence: what support is provided at each stage, and what is the specific condition for withdrawing each scaffold. Pairs compare and discuss the risk of under-scaffolding vs. over-scaffolding. <i>Purpose: Develops precision in scaffold design; challenges the common pattern of providing scaffolds that are never removed.</i>
Rubric Calibration Protocol	Assessment Design	40–50 min	Pairs or triads	Participants design one analytic rubric for a shared performance task, then independently apply it to three samples of student work. Scores are compared: where do raters agree? Where do they diverge? Language is revised until at least 85% inter-rater consistency is achieved. <i>Purpose: Develops rubric validity and shared understanding of performance standards; models the calibration process teachers should use before assigning any rubric-assessed task.</i>
SAMR Technology Audit	Technology Integration	30–40 min	Individual then group	Participants list every piece of technology used in their classroom in the last month and place each on the SAMR matrix. They then identify one tool currently at Substitution level and redesign its use to reach

				Modification or Redefinition, presenting the redesigned use with a pedagogical rationale. <i>Purpose: Creates honest self-assessment of current technology practice; provides a concrete upgrade pathway.</i>
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Common Challenges & Trainer Solutions

The following challenges are consistently encountered in teacher professional development programs. Each entry includes context, specific trainer responses, and practical solutions rooted in the instructional design principles of this program.

CHALLENGE 1: Participant Resistance to New Approaches

Context: Some teachers arrive with fixed beliefs about what "real teaching" looks like and may dismiss new strategies as impractical or theoretical.

Recommended Responses:

- Anchor every strategy in research evidence and student outcome data, not just educational fashion
- Invite sceptical participants to describe specifically what they fear might not work — then address that concern directly
- Use the phrase "try it as an experiment, not a commitment" to lower the stakes of exploration
- Share your own experience of encountering the same resistance and what shifted your perspective

CHALLENGE 2: Unequal Participation in Cooperative Activities

Context: In group work activities, some participants dominate while others disengage or defer.

Recommended Responses:

- Assign explicit roles with rotating responsibilities (facilitator, recorder, reporter, timekeeper)
- Use structured accountability measures: individual written responses before group discussion
- Debrief the dynamic openly — make the participation pattern visible and discuss what it tells us about our own cooperative learning design
- Use pair work before group work when participation is consistently unequal

CHALLENGE 3: Difficulty Contextualizing Strategies to Participants' Settings

Context: Teachers working in low-resource, high-stakes, or very traditional institutional contexts may feel that strategies like PBL or flipped learning are impossible in their reality.

Recommended Responses:

- Build in time for "How might I adapt this?" discussions after every major strategy introduction
- Invite the group to problem-solve together: how might DI work with 45 students and no copier?
- Emphasize minimum viable versions: "What is the smallest possible version of this that you could try next week?"
- Celebrate small adaptations as genuine innovations, not as compromises

CHALLENGE 4: Participants Who Are Struggling to Transfer Learning

Context: Some participants engage well during training sessions but cannot translate concepts into lesson design or live practice.

Recommended Responses:

- Increase the ratio of application to input time — reduce lecture and increase workshop
- Require every strategy input to be followed by a design task directly connected to participants' own curriculum
- Use peer coaching pairs who check in with each other between sessions on implementation attempts
- Offer differentiated support: "office hours" or brief one-to-one coaching for participants who need it

CHALLENGE 5: Managing Emotional Responses to Reflective Practice

Context: Reflection activities, particularly around teaching identity and past failures, can surface emotional responses including shame, defensiveness, or grief.

Recommended Responses:

- Establish psychological safety norms explicitly at the start of the program and revisit them whenever necessary
- Never require public sharing of private reflections — always make sharing optional
- Normalize difficult emotions as evidence of investment, not weakness
- Have private check-in conversations with participants who appear distressed; provide support or referral as appropriate

CHALLENGE 6: Time Management During Workshop Days

Context: Design tasks consistently take longer than planned, leaving insufficient time for feedback and reflection.

Recommended Responses:

- Use visible timers displayed throughout the room — participants regulate their own pace better with visual time cues
- Plan for sessions to be 20% longer than you think they need to be — workshop day underestimation is universal
- Use "minimum viable product" framing: "What is the most essential element you need to design in the next 10 minutes?"
- Build in decision checkpoints: "You have 15 minutes left — choose to complete one element well rather than three elements partially"

CHALLENGE 7: Inconsistent Prior Knowledge Across Participants

Context: Some teachers arrive with extensive professional development backgrounds; others are newer to formal pedagogical frameworks.

Recommended Responses:

- Use a pre-program needs analysis to map the range of prior knowledge and plan for it
- Design activities that work at multiple levels: experienced teachers extend through reflection and mentoring; newer teachers build through direct application
- Leverage experienced participants as resources — their classroom wisdom enriches the

group rather than creating a hierarchy

- Avoid assuming shared reference points; always provide brief contextual framing before introducing any framework

CHALLENGE 8: Sustaining Momentum Through Week 3 and 4

Context: Engagement and attendance sometimes decline in the second half of the program as institutional demands compete with professional development.

Recommended Responses:

- Build personal accountability structures from Day 1: peer partners, SMART goals, public commitments
- Make Week 3 and 4 content visibly relevant by connecting it directly to participants' real classroom challenges
- Celebrate progress explicitly and publicly: acknowledge what has shifted and what participants have already tried
- Create a "between-session challenge" structure: small, concrete implementation tasks participants try between days and briefly report on at the start of the next session

CHALLENGE 9: Assessment of Participant Learning in the Program Itself

Context: Trainers sometimes struggle to assess whether participants are genuinely developing — or simply performing engagement.

Recommended Responses:

- Use the program's own formative assessment techniques on participants: exit tickets, reflection journals, lesson audits provide evidence of growth
- Focus assessment on observable behavior change and design quality rather than attitude or verbal assent
- Use the Observation Checklist during workshop days as an authentic assessment tool
- The Action Research design in the capstone session is itself the most authentic summative assessment: it reveals what participants genuinely understand and what they are willing to commit to

CHALLENGE 10: Building a Genuine Learning Community

Context: In short-cycle programs, superficial niceties can masquerade as community. Without genuine psychological safety and mutual vulnerability, depth of learning is limited.

Recommended Responses:

- Model vulnerability yourself as the trainer from Day 1 — name something you are still learning or refining in your own practice
- Use structured protocols for sharing that go beyond surface opinions (e.g., save the last word, philosophical chairs, concentric circles)
- Revisit group agreements at the start of each week and invite modifications as the community deepens
- The micro-teaching and live demonstration workshops are community-building events as much as assessment events — treat them with that intentionality

Tips & Approaches for Trainers

The following evidence-informed practices are organized by category and drawn from research on effective professional development facilitation, adult learning, and instructional coaching. These are not rules — they are calibrations, based on what consistently works in training contexts similar to this program.

Facilitation Principles

- Model every strategy you teach: if you are advocating for active learning, your training sessions must themselves be models of active learning
- Maintain a ratio of no more than 20% input to 80% application — the temptation to talk more when you know more is a facilitation trap
- Use participant's language back to them: reflect their exact words when summarizing insights to build ownership of the learning
- Ask before telling: use open, genuine questions before providing explanations; every explanation you give replaces a discovery that the participant could have made
- Pause longer than feels comfortable — silence during reflection is productive, not empty; resist the urge to fill it

Designing Sessions for Transfer

- Every session should end with: "What will you try this week?" — not as a formality but as a genuine design prompt connected to participants' actual next lesson
- Build explicit bridges between sessions: begin each day with a brief check-in on what participants tried since the last session and what they noticed
- Use "minimum viable application" to reduce transfer anxiety: always identify the smallest possible version of a strategy that could be tried in the next 48 hours
- Design application tasks that use participants' own curriculum materials, not generic examples — authenticity is the most powerful transfer mechanism
- Return to the same concepts from multiple angles across the four weeks — spaced repetition is a design principle, not just a memory strategy

Differentiation for Adult Learners

- Apply DI principles to your own training design: some participants will need more scaffolding, others will need extension challenges and opportunities to lead
- Offer structured choice in application tasks: "Choose one of the following three options..." models the very practice you are teaching
- Differentiate the feedback you give during workshops: more experienced participants benefit from higher-challenge questions; newer participants need more explicit guidance
- Honor experiential knowledge — career experience is a resource, not a barrier; design activities that activate and build on what participants already know
- Recognize that some learning will be uncomfortable and plan for it: growth without discomfort is surface-level change, not genuine professional development.

Assessment of the Program Itself

- Use the program's own formative assessment tools on participants: exit tickets, KWL charts, and traffic lights give you real data about where participants are
- Collect mid-program feedback at the end of Week 2 and make at least one visible change in response — this models exactly the formative-responsive teaching cycle you are advocating for
- The quality of participants' lesson designs, reflections, and capstone projects is your primary summative data; use rubrics for consistency
- Compare participants' Week 1 teaching inventory responses with their Week 4 reflections — the shift (or absence of shift) is a genuine program evaluation data point

Managing the Learning Environment

- Arrange seating for cooperation from Day 1: clusters of 4 rather than rows signal the social, collaborative nature of the program before a word is spoken
- Display learning principles visibly in the room throughout the program: post the week's key frameworks where they are visible during application activities
- Create a dedicated physical or digital wall for participants' lesson designs, reflections, and commitments — visibility builds accountability and community
- Manage energy across the day by alternating high-engagement activity with quieter individual reflection; a full day of group work is as exhausting as a full day of lecture
- Protect transition time between activities: five minutes of genuine transition is more productive than rushing from one activity into the next before participants have processed

Recommended Resources & Further Reading

The following resources form the theoretical and practical foundation of this program. Trainers and participants are encouraged to explore those most relevant to their professional context.

Foundational Books

1. Tomlinson, C.A. (2014). *The Differentiated Classroom: Responding to the Needs of All Learners* (2nd ed.). ASCD.
2. Wiggins, G. & McTighe, J. (2005). *Understanding by Design* (2nd ed.). ASCD.
3. Hattie, J. (2012). *Visible Learning for Teachers: Maximizing Impact on Learning*. Routledge.
4. Knowles, M., Holton, E. & Swanson, R. (2015). *The Adult Learner: The Definitive Classic in Adult Education* (8th ed.). Routledge.
5. Kolb, D.A. (1984). *Experiential Learning: Experience as the Source of Learning and Development*. Prentice Hall.
6. Schon, D.A. (1983). *The Reflective Practitioner: How Professionals Think in Action*. Basic Books.
7. Black, P. & Wiliam, D. (1998). *Inside the Black Box: Raising Standards Through Classroom Assessment*. Phi Delta Kappa International.
8. Weimer, M. (2013). *Learner-Centered Teaching: Five Key Changes to Practice* (2nd ed.). Jossey-Bass.
9. Kagan, S. (1994). *Cooperative Learning*. Resources for Teachers Inc.
10. CAST (2018). *Universal Design for Learning Guidelines Version 2.2*. Retrieved from udlguidelines.cast.org

Key Articles

1. Freeman, S. et al. (2014). Active learning increases student performance in science, engineering, and mathematics. *PNAS*, 111(23), 8410–8415.
2. Hattie, J. & Timperley, H. (2007). The Power of Feedback. *Review of Educational Research*, 77(1), 81–112.
3. Csikszentmihalyi, M. (1990). *Flow: The Psychology of Optimal Experience*. Harper & Row.
4. Marzano, R.J. (2007). *The Art and Science of Teaching*. ASCD.
5. Bruner, J.S. (1978). The role of dialogue in language acquisition. In Sinclair, Jarvella & Levelt (Eds.), *The Child's Conception of Language*. Springer.

Frameworks & Online Resources

1. Buck Institute for Education — Gold Standard PBL Framework: www.pblworks.org
2. CAST — UDL Guidelines and Implementation Resources: www.cast.org
3. Edutopia — Research-Based Teacher Professional Development: www.edutopia.org
4. TESOL International Association — Professional Teaching Standards: www.tesol.org
5. Dylan Wiliam — Embedded Formative Assessment Research and Tools: www.dylanwiliam.org

Appendices

The following appendices are designed for printing and distribution to participants. Each is a standalone tool that supports specific program activities.

APPENDIX A — Pre-Program Needs Analysis Survey

Instructions: This survey is completed before the program begins and is used by the trainer to understand participants' starting points, priorities, and concerns. Responses are confidential and used for program calibration only.

Section 1: Professional Context

1. How many years of teaching experience do you have? (Under 2 years / 2–5 years / 6–10 years / Over 10 years)
2. What level(s) do you currently teach? (Primary / Secondary / Adult / Higher Education / Multiple)
3. What is your primary subject area or teaching context?
4. Describe your current school or institution in two or three sentences.

Section 2: Current Practice Self-Assessment

Rate each statement from 1 (Not yet practicing) to 5 (Consistently and confidently practicing):

1. I design lessons that respond to different learners' needs within the same class.
2. I regularly use formative assessment to adjust my teaching during a lesson.
3. I can clearly articulate the difference between accommodation and modification.
4. I use cooperative learning structures rather than unstructured group work.
5. I regularly reflect on my practice in a structured, documented way.
6. I design assessments before planning instructional activities.

Section 3: Priorities and Concerns

1. Which two teaching areas are you most eager to develop through this program?
2. What is one challenge in your current classroom that you hope this program will help you address?
3. What concerns, if any, do you have about participating in this program?
4. What would make this program genuinely valuable for you — what does success look like at the end?

APPENDIX B — Lesson Observation Checklist

Observer: _____ Teacher: _____

Date: _____

Instructions: Use this checklist during micro-teaching segments and workshop day observations. Circle the rating for each indicator. Add specific evidence in the notes column.

INDICATOR	1 — Not yet evident	2 — Partially evident	3 — Clearly evident	EVIDENCE / NOTES
The lesson objective is clear, communicated, and measurable	1	2	3	
Students are cognitively active for the majority of the session	1	2	3	
The teacher gives clear, complete instructions before releasing students to a task	1	2	3	
At least one learner-centered element is present (choice, voice, or relevance)	1	2	3	
The teacher checks for understanding at least twice during the session	1	2	3	
Students are given an opportunity to produce language, meaning, or knowledge (not just receive it)	1	2	3	
The task is appropriately challenging for the level of the learners	1	2	3	
The teacher provides specific, descriptive feedback at least once	1	2	3	
The session includes a reflection or consolidation moment	1	2	3	
Evidence of at least one differentiation, accommodation, or UDL element is visible	1	2	3	

Glow (Strength Observed):

Grow (One Growth Area):

Wonder (One Question for the Teacher):

APPENDIX C — Lesson Plan Template

Teacher Name	
Date	
Subject / Level	
Lesson Title	
Duration	
Number of Students	
Lesson Sequence	Lesson ____ of ____ in the unit

Lesson Objective(s)

By the end of this lesson, learners will be able to:

- 1.
- 2.
3. (optional)

Differentiation & Accommodation Notes

Learner profiles considered in this lesson:

Readiness differentiation:

Interest / learning profile differentiation:

Accommodation strategies applied:

TIME	TEACHER ACTIVITY	LEARNER ACTIVITY	RESOURCES	ASSESSMENT / ICQ
____ mins	Warm-up / Activation			
____ mins	Input / Instruction			
____ mins	Guided Practice			
____ mins	Independent / Cooperative Practice			
____ mins	Reflection / Wrap-up			

Post-Lesson Reflection (5R Framework)

Report: What happened?

Respond: How did I feel about it?

Relate: How does this connect to what I know?

Reason: Why did it happen this way?

Reconstruct: What will I do differently next time?

APPENDIX D — Reflection Journal Prompts

Participants are encouraged to select one prompt per day from the list below in addition to the session-specific reflection provided at the end of each session plan. These prompts are designed to deepen professional self-awareness and to connect program learning to lived classroom experience.

Identity & Philosophy

1. What do you believe learning looks like — not what you think you should believe, but what your classroom behavior suggests you believe?
2. Who is the most influential teacher you ever had? What specifically did they do — and how does it show up in your own teaching?
3. If your students were asked to describe you as a teacher in three words, what would they say? What three words would you want them to say?
4. What teaching habit are you most proud of? What teaching habit are you most aware of needing to change?

Differentiation & Inclusion

1. Think of the three most varied learners in your current class. Does your typical lesson genuinely serve all three? Be specific.
2. When a student struggles in your class, what is your default interpretation: a learning problem, a motivation problem, a design problem, or a barrier problem?
3. What would it mean for your teaching to treat cognitive and learning diversity as the norm rather than the exception?
4. Describe one moment in your career when you set low expectations for a learner and were wrong. What did that experience teach you?

Active Learning & Engagement

1. On a scale of 1–10, how much genuine cognitive work do your students do in a typical lesson — as opposed to compliance activity? What would a 9 or 10 look like?
2. What does student engagement look like in your classroom? How do you know when it is genuine versus performed?
3. What is the biggest obstacle to active learning in your current context? Is it an external constraint — or an internal one?

Assessment & Feedback

1. When you return a piece of assessed work to a student, what do they typically do with your feedback? What does that tell you about the quality and usability of your feedback?
2. How confident are you that your students know what success looks like before they begin a task? What would change if they did?
3. What is the last formative check you used that genuinely surprised you? What did you do with that information?

Professional Growth & Sustainability

1. What does your professional growth look like between formal professional development opportunities? Is it systematic, or incidental?
2. What is one change you have made in your teaching as a direct result of this program so far? What do you notice about your students' response to it?
3. Write your Teaching Transformation Commitment in three sentences: what you will do, how you will know it is working, and when you will review it.